

My illegal Emotion

By Ibrahim Ahmad

I think that in this world, I cannot show my real emotions because I do not truly feel happiness, sadness, or anger. I only feel empty. Sometimes, it feels like I do not feel anything at all, so I simply copy the emotions of other people. This feeling is the main reason why I want to write this story.

One day, my friend called me and invited me to his birthday party. He sounded so happy, and I did not understand why. It was just a birthday. Why was he so excited? Why did it give him happiness instead of emptiness? Before leaving, I stood in front of the mirror and trained myself on how to react at the party. I practiced smiling, laughing, and pretending to enjoy things. I kept overthinking every possible situation. Then I booked a taxi. When the driver arrived, I sat in the back seat quietly. The driver looked tired and sad. After a few minutes, he suddenly said, "I hate my work. Every day it's just driving, driving, and driving. I feel so sad doing this." I did not know how to react. I never understood sadness or happiness naturally. So, I stared at his face carefully and copied his expression, hoping it looked real enough. I prayed he would never realize that I was only imitating his emotions. Then the taxi stopped, and I walked toward the birthday party.

At the birthday party, everyone looked so happy. They were laughing, dancing, and enjoying everything. When my friend saw me, he came to me with a big smile and welcomed me. I said, "Happy birthday," but I forgot to smile while saying it. He looked at me with a confused face, and then I realized something important. If you say "happy birthday" to someone, you are supposed to smile. That became another lesson for me and also another embarrassing moment.

Later, everyone started dancing. One person invited me to dance with them. I went to the dance floor and copied their moves, but I felt nothing inside.

Everyone looked at me strangely, like I was an alien trying to act like a human. That was when I realized dancing also needs emotion. Everything in this world needs emotion. Talking to people, laughing, dancing, even jobs and relationships.

After that, I stayed away from everyone and hid myself in quiet corners so nobody would invite me to do anything else. I watched people from far away and studied how naturally they smiled and laughed. Meanwhile, I still felt empty. I started thinking that maybe I was born in the wrong universe, a universe made for people who can truly feel emotions. Finally, I left my friend's house and went back home alone.

After coming home, I tried to watch a comedy show on TV. The audience in the show was laughing loudly after every joke, and sometimes people even clapped. I listened carefully to the jokes, trying to understand what was so funny about them. The jokes were okay, but I still could not understand why everyone was laughing so much. Why did those words create happiness inside people? Why did they smile so naturally?

For a few seconds, I forced myself to laugh softly, just to see how it felt, but it sounded fake even to me. The room became quiet again. I stared at the TV screen while the audience continued laughing in the background like a sound effect made for humans, not for me.

After some time, I turned the TV off and started doing random things to distract myself. I cleaned my desk, opened my laptop, and walked around my room without any reason. It felt easier to stay busy than to sit alone with my thoughts.

So, this is just my little novel to show my real emotions because I can't show my real emotions to real people because they never understand so I think my reader can understand.

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